

# **My Journey**

## **Building Responsible AI Through Policy, Governance, and Human-Centered Innovation**

For more than a decade, my work has been driven by a single conviction: technology should strengthen institutions, expand opportunity, and improve people's lives. My professional journey has taken me across Africa, the Middle East, Europe, and Asia, working at the intersection of artificial intelligence, digital governance, public policy, and social innovation.

Today, I advise governments, international organizations, research institutions, and civil society on responsible AI, digital transformation, institutional capacity building, and public sector innovation. Yet my journey began long before artificial intelligence became a global priority.

It began with people.

### **2011–2013**

#### **Empowering Youth During Tunisia's Democratic Transition**

My professional career started during one of the most transformative moments in Tunisia's modern history. Following the 2011 Revolution, I joined the **Tunisian Forum for Youth Development**, where I helped young people become active participants in rebuilding democratic institutions.

As Team Leader and Digital Communication Assistant, I co-developed communication strategies that encouraged civic participation, coordinated volunteer networks, and managed digital engagement initiatives designed to amplify youth voices in national dialogue.

This experience introduced me to the power of digital technologies as instruments of democratic participation. It also taught me that meaningful transformation depends not only on technology but on inclusive institutions, stakeholder engagement, and trust between governments and citizens.

These early years established the foundations of my work in digital governance, institutional collaboration, and public engagement.

### **2014–2017**

#### **Advancing Regional Policy at the African Union**

I joined the **African Union Campaign to End Child Marriage in Africa**, based in Addis Ababa, where I contributed to one of the continent's largest policy and advocacy initiatives focused on protecting girls' rights.

Working across multiple African Union Member States, I coordinated regional consultations involving governments, Regional Economic Communities, United Nations agencies, development partners, and civil society organizations.

My responsibilities included conducting policy and regulatory analysis, mapping institutional and legal frameworks, collecting and analysing evidence, and producing policy briefs that informed continental strategies. I also contributed to monitoring and evaluation systems, knowledge management, and evidence-based advocacy supporting regional decision-making.

One of the highlights of this period was co-organising the **First African Girls Summit** in Lusaka, Zambia, which brought together policymakers, young leaders, and international partners to strengthen continental collaboration around gender equality.

This role significantly strengthened my expertise in government advisory, stakeholder engagement, institutional capacity building, and regional policy development—skills that would later become central to my work in AI governance.

## 2018–2020

### Driving Digital Transformation Across the African Union

Following my regional policy experience, I joined the **Office of the African Union Special Youth Envoy** as **Youth, Gender and Digital Transformation Advisor**.

This role marked an important shift toward digital transformation and institutional innovation.

I supported the digitisation of internal workflows, knowledge management systems, and communication platforms, helping improve collaboration across African Union Member States. I worked to strengthen youth participation through digital tools while supporting institutional modernization and more efficient programme delivery.

Beyond technology implementation, I contributed to broader public sector digital transformation by supporting digital strategy implementation, institutional coordination, digital cooperation, and stakeholder engagement across multiple countries.

This experience deepened my understanding that successful digital transformation is not merely about adopting new technologies—it requires governance frameworks, institutional readiness, leadership, and people-centred change management.

These lessons continue to shape my approach to AI governance today.

## 2020–2022

## Human Rights, Digital Inclusion, and Responsible Innovation

Returning to Tunisia, I joined the **Arab Institute for Human Rights** as Senior Advocacy Specialist, where my work expanded beyond traditional human rights into the growing relationship between technology and society.

I led national advocacy initiatives supporting migrants, women, and vulnerable communities while promoting access to healthcare, legal protection, and social inclusion.

Working alongside governments, international organizations, and civil society, I contributed to policy advocacy on technology-facilitated harms, online safety, digital inclusion, and the ethical use of emerging technologies.

This period reinforced my belief that digital transformation must be guided by human rights, equity, and social justice. It also strengthened my expertise in multi-stakeholder dialogue, institutional collaboration, public policy, and digital governance—areas that would become central to my international work in responsible AI.

**2022**

## Advancing National Digital Transformation in Mauritania and STEM.

In 2022, I joined **Infolog Group** as a Digital Transformation and Digital Inclusion Consultant, contributing to the implementation of Mauritania's National Digital Transformation Strategy through the CACHILY Project. Working alongside government institutions, telecommunications operators, financial institutions, development partners, and local stakeholders, I supported initiatives designed to expand access to digital technologies and strengthen financial inclusion.

My work focused on connecting policy with implementation. I contributed to the development of digital public services, supported e-Government initiatives, and facilitated collaboration between the public and private sectors to improve the country's digital ecosystem. I also designed and delivered capacity-building programmes for entrepreneurs on digital entrepreneurship, innovation, and Design Thinking, helping strengthen institutional capabilities and foster a more inclusive digital economy.

This experience reinforced my understanding that digital transformation is ultimately about empowering people, strengthening institutions, and ensuring that technological progress creates opportunities for everyone.

**2022**

# Contributing to the Global Conversation on AI Ethics

As artificial intelligence began reshaping societies around the world, I increasingly focused my work on understanding its ethical, social, and governance implications.

As an expert contributor to **AI Ethics Course.org**, I provided analysis for educational content examining algorithmic bias, online harms, hate speech, and culturally grounded approaches to responsible AI. My contribution emphasized that effective AI governance cannot rely solely on technical safeguards—it must also reflect cultural diversity, social realities, and human values.

This marked the beginning of my transition from digital transformation into international AI governance.

## 2023

## Measuring Responsible AI Across Africa

In 2023, I joined the **Global Index on Responsible AI (GIRAI)** as an **AI Policy Researcher and Francophone Africa Lead**, a role that significantly expanded my work across the African continent.

Working with governments, regulatory authorities, academic institutions, civil society organisations, and private-sector leaders, I assessed national AI governance readiness through one of the world's most comprehensive responsible AI benchmarking initiatives.

My work combined policy research with practical engagement. I conducted policy and regulatory analysis, evaluated national governance frameworks, collected qualitative and quantitative evidence, and facilitated high-level consultations with Ministries of Digital Economy, Technology, Innovation, and national regulators.

Beyond research, I led stakeholder engagement workshops that identified governance gaps, regulatory priorities, and opportunities for responsible AI adoption across Francophone Africa. Through digital ecosystem assessments, stakeholder mapping, and evidence-based policy recommendations, I contributed to government advisory processes supporting national AI strategies and responsible digital transformation.

This role provided invaluable insight into how different countries approach AI governance, highlighting both the shared opportunities and the unique challenges facing the Global South.

## 2024

# Helping Shape Tunisia's Responsible AI Landscape

In 2024, I served as **AI Policy Advocacy Consultant** for **GIZ Tunisia**, supporting national and regional discussions on responsible artificial intelligence.

Working with policymakers, government institutions, civil society organisations, researchers, and international partners, I contributed to the development of practical recommendations for ethical AI implementation in Tunisia.

My work extended beyond policy advocacy. I advised on digital governance, digital policy, regulatory frameworks, institutional coordination, and digital transformation strategies while conducting policy and regulatory analysis, digital ecosystem assessments, and stakeholder mapping.

This experience strengthened my expertise in government advisory and demonstrated how responsible AI can become an integral component of national digital transformation strategies.

## 2025

# Leading Research on AI Governance and Gender

My appointment as **AI and Gender Fellow Researcher** at the **Global Center on AI Governance** marked another important milestone in my career.

My research examines the intersection of artificial intelligence, gender, public policy, and digital governance within African contexts. I contribute to the implementation of the African Union Continental AI Strategy by developing evidence-based policy recommendations that promote responsible AI, digital inclusion, data governance, and women's leadership.

My work includes policy and regulatory analysis, stakeholder engagement, institutional capacity building, government advisory, and research supporting public sector digital transformation.

More broadly, my research explores how AI governance frameworks can reflect the realities of African societies while strengthening public institutions and protecting fundamental rights.

## 2025

# Supervising Responsible AI Research Across Africa and the MENA Region

As **Regional Supervisor (MENA & Africa)** for the **Global Index on Responsible AI**, I oversee multidisciplinary research teams responsible for evaluating national AI governance systems across multiple countries.

My responsibilities include supervising research methodologies, ensuring evidence quality, supporting stakeholder engagement, and guiding assessments of transparency, accountability, explainability, and inclusion.

Through digital ecosystem assessments, policy analysis, stakeholder mapping, and regulatory evaluation, I help generate evidence that informs national AI strategies and supports governments in strengthening responsible digital governance.

This work allows me to contribute directly to the development of AI governance systems across diverse political, cultural, and regulatory contexts.

**2025**

## Educating the Next Generation of Responsible AI Leaders

Education has become an essential pillar of my work.

As **Module Lead and Expert Contributor** for the **UNESCO–LG Global MOOC on the Ethics of AI**, I developed the Human–AI Interaction module for one of UNESCO's flagship global education initiatives.

The course integrates international ethical standards with African and MENA perspectives, drawing on concepts such as Ubuntu and Hikma to demonstrate that responsible AI must be culturally grounded as well as technically robust.

Through this work, I have contributed to making AI ethics education more globally representative, ensuring that perspectives from Africa and the Global South become part of international conversations on AI governance.

**2026**

**Present**

# Advising on Artificial Intelligence and Technology-Facilitated Gender-Based Violence

As a member of the **UNFPA Tunisia Expert Group on Technology-Facilitated Gender-Based Violence and Artificial Intelligence**, I contribute technical expertise to one of the most urgent policy challenges created by emerging technologies.

Working alongside specialists from multiple disciplines, I support policy recommendations, expert consultations, and multi-stakeholder dialogue focused on AI governance, digital safety, women's rights, and responsible technology design.

This work reflects my broader commitment to ensuring that innovation strengthens human rights rather than undermining them, particularly for women and vulnerable communities.

## Present

### Building CHIFAA: Responsible AI for Women's Health

While my work with governments and international organisations has shaped policies, my most personal project is **CHIFAA**.

Founded after my own experience as a breast cancer survivor, CHIFAA is North Africa's first survivor-led AI companion designed to support women living with breast and cervical cancer.

The platform combines responsible AI, digital governance, ethical data governance, digital public services, and human-centred design to provide culturally grounded, multilingual support tailored to the realities of women across North Africa.

Beyond technology, CHIFAA represents a new model of innovation—one in which lived experience is recognised as expertise and patients become active partners in designing digital health solutions.

By bringing together clinicians, AI researchers, policymakers, survivors, and civil society organisations, CHIFAA demonstrates how inclusive governance can produce technologies that are both innovative and deeply human.

## Looking Ahead

My work continues through **HIKMA AI**, an initiative dedicated to advancing ethical, culturally grounded, and human-centred artificial intelligence inspired by the intellectual traditions of Africa and the Global South.

Across every role I have held—from youth engagement and continental policy to AI governance and public sector digital transformation—one principle has remained constant:

**Technology is most powerful when it strengthens institutions, expands opportunity, and serves humanity with wisdom, dignity, and justice.**